

Spanish Major (33 credits)

The Spanish major offers students the opportunity to develop advanced proficiency in Spanish while gaining a deep understanding of the cultures, histories, and contemporary realities of the Spanish-speaking world. The major emphasizes linguistic competence, cultural literacy, and critical thinking, and prepares students for a wide range of professional pathways, graduate study, and community engagement.

Students choose **one of two options** within the major. Both options require a minimum of **33 credits** completed with a grade of **C or better** in each course.

Option 1: Spanish for Communities and Professions

This option is designed for students who wish to combine Spanish with another field of study or professional interest. It is particularly appropriate for students interested in careers in health, education, environmental studies, public service, business, social sciences, international relations, or community-based work, as well as for students seeking to deepen their understanding of family or cultural heritage.

Students in this option develop strong language skills while exploring how Spanish functions in diverse social, cultural, and professional contexts.

Requirements

A. Required Courses (4–6 courses [12-18 credits], depending on placement)

Selected from the following:

- 201 / 203
- 202 / 204
- 215 Introduction to Hispanic Literature and Culture
- 261 Introduction to the Study of Language
- 271 Introduction to Translation
- 353 Spanish for Community Engagement

B. Electives (5–7 [15-21 credits] courses, depending on placement)

- At least **three courses must be at the 300 level or above**
- Courses may be taught in Spanish, English, or Portuguese

Up to **6 credits** may be taken outside the department with approval from the Undergraduate Director. Examples of relevant fields include (but are not limited to): Latino and Caribbean Studies, Geography, Political Science, Comparative Literature, Cognitive Science, Computer Science, Linguistics, Environmental Studies, Public Health, Business, and related areas. Students are not limited to this list.

Option 2: Language Intensive

The Language Intensive option is intended for students seeking advanced proficiency in Spanish and sustained engagement with literature, language, bilingualism/Second Language acquisition, and translation. This option is appropriate for students considering graduate study, teaching Spanish, translation and interpretation, or careers that require high levels of linguistic and cultural expertise.

Requirements

A. Required Lower-Division Courses (9 credits)

- 215 Introduction to Hispanic Literature and Culture
- 261 Introduction to the Study of Language
- 271 Introduction to Translation

Note: Courses 201/203 and 202/204 may count toward the major as electives, allowing students to make progress toward the major early in their coursework.

B. Upper-Division Requirements (12 credits)

- A minimum of **12 credits at the 300 level or above**

C. Electives (12 credits)

- Spanish courses from the 200–400 level
- Up to 3 credits in Portuguese (810) may count toward the major
- Up to 3 credits in courses taught in English (940) may count toward the major

Additional Notes for Both Options

- Major credit begins at the 200 level.
- Students are encouraged, but not required, to enroll in 400-level courses when available.
- Course sequencing is flexible.
- Students should meet regularly with a departmental advisor to plan a coherent and timely path through the major.